

Electrolyte Imbalances

Notice the direction, connect it to symptoms, and protect the heart and brain while escalating.

Potassium - Low or high potassium can disturb cardiac rhythm and muscle function. - Check renal status, GI losses, medications, and ECG context. - Never treat a number without verifying the result and order.	Sodium - Sodium disorders commonly show neurologic changes because water shifts affect the brain. - Track fluid balance, weight, intake/output, and trend. - Correction rate is a provider-managed safety issue; avoid rapid unplanned changes.
Calcium and magnesium - Low levels can increase neuromuscular irritability. - High levels can reduce reflexes or alertness. - Watch respiratory, cardiac, and seizure safety cues.	

Reviewed 2026-07-13 - Source: MedlinePlus, U.S. National Library of Medicine - <https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/electrolyte-panel/>
Study aid only. Verify current references, instructor guidance, scope, orders, and facility policy.